GMS WEEKLY
Your Source for Recycling News

October 23rd, 2026
Week 43
Volume 282, Issue 1258

QUOTE of the WEEK

"The difficulty lies, not in the new ideas, but in escaping from the old ones..."
- John Maynard Keynes

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

Click "Ctrl" + below to launch the GMS Weekly Summary Podcast

Highlights:

- **Freight Rebounds**
- **Crude Climbs**
- **Supply Scarce**
- **Steel Diverges**

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FREIGHT REFUSES TO STAY DOWN

Last week's dry freight retreat appeared to offer recycling buyers the opening they had been waiting for. It did not last. The Baltic Dry Index recovered from 2,545 on October 15 to 2,693 on Thursday, October 22, led by improving Capesize earnings. Although still below earlier October levels, the recovery has restored some confidence in continued trading. For recyclers hoping that softer freight would finally release ageing bulkers, the window of opportunity has already narrowed.

The energy market supplied a more worrying development. Renewed Houthi attacks in Saudi Arabia heightened concerns over Middle Eastern oil supplies, prompting Saudi Aramco to evacuate its Dhahran headquarters on Thursday. Brent climbed above USD 115 per barrel intraday on Friday, its highest level since early May, while WTI moved above USD 100. With Gulf shipping risks and elevated insurance costs continuing to disrupt normal trading patterns, ageing tankers still have compelling reasons to remain employed rather than head for recycling.

Dry bulk's recovery was uneven. Capesizes strengthened to 3,848, while Supramaxes advanced to 1,890. Panamaxes, however, retreated to 2,151, illustrating the different pressures facing individual vessel segments. The broader message remains unchanged: freight earnings and second-hand alternatives continue to discourage owners from releasing sufficient recycling candidates. One week's decline was encouraging. Its partial reversal has reminded buyers how quickly that encouragement can disappear.

Steel markets offered little common direction. Indian plate strengthened during the week, while Bangladesh, Pakistan and China remained unchanged. Domestic finished-steel consumption continues to disappoint across much of the sub-continent, limiting the benefit of otherwise stable steel quotations. Turkey weakened marginally against the international market, although its central bank reduced interest rates from 37% to 36%, offering modest financing relief amid continued currency pressure.

Physical waterfront activity nevertheless continued. Alang received additional general cargo and reefer tonnage, Chattogram completed several smaller vessel deliveries, and Gadani welcomed another previously secured bulker. These movements sustain yard operations without signalling a corresponding improvement in fresh recycling sales. The distinction remains important: ships are reaching the beaches, but the next pipeline is still far from full.

Bangladesh continues to display the strongest conventional buying appetite, although suitable candidates remain scarce. Pakistan retains healthy underlying demand with greater purchasing discipline, while India continues to benefit from specialist opportunities and improving local steel. Turkey remains cautious as weak domestic consumption restricts further buying enthusiasm.

The final quarter is therefore developing much as it began, with buyers seeking tonnage that owners have little urgency to release. Freight has recovered, steel offers mixed support, and recycling demand remains largely intact. The beaches are ready for more business. The ships, for now, still have other plans.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 43 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

CHATTOGRAM LOOKS TO THE DRY SEASON

Appetite Persists.

Chattogram continues to display healthy recycling demand, although the persistent shortage of available candidates is restricting fresh transactional activity. End buyers remain interested in suitable bulkers, tankers and container vessels, with yard requirements supporting the market despite disappointing domestic steel consumption. Local plate remained unchanged at BDT 66,000 per ton throughout the week, offering stability but little encouragement for further improvement. The underlying challenge remains the imbalance between demand for ships and owners' willingness to release them. Freight earnings and second-hand values continue to offer attractive alternatives, leaving Chattogram buyers competing for a limited selection of workable tonnage.

Berths Turn.

The waterfront has remained active, with four smaller vessels completing delivery during the week, including three tankers and a general cargo unit. Larger previously secured vessels remain in the pipeline, providing further work for recycling yards once delivery arrangements are completed. Attention is now turning towards the October 25 to 28 delivery tides, although the extended Durga Puja banking closure from October 20 to 24 has required additional coordination of documentation and settlement arrangements. Essential services at designated port-related bank branches are expected to support necessary transactions. Physical movements remain encouraging, but the number of fresh candidates continues to fall short of buyers' requirements.

Season Approaches.

Sentiment remains cautiously positive as Bangladesh approaches the dry season. Recyclers are hopeful that improving construction activity and more favourable operating conditions will gradually support local steel consumption. For the moment, however, finished-steel demand remains sluggish, with mills and stockists showing little urgency to rebuild inventories. Seasonal improvement therefore remains an expectation rather than an established recovery. Chattogram enters the coming weeks with available yard capacity, willing buyers and stable steel values. What it needs next is stronger downstream consumption and a more consistent flow of recycling candidates. The demand is present. The anticipated seasonal recovery must still prove itself.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA



ALANG FINDS FIRM GROUND IN STEEL

Steel Strengthens.

Alang received some welcome support from its domestic steel market this week, with plate strengthening from INR 42,300 to INR 43,300 per ton. The improvement also lifted its Dollar equivalent, offering recyclers better underlying steel realisations at a time when fresh vessel availability remains limited. Nevertheless, stronger steel has not materially altered India's competitive position against Bangladesh and Pakistan for conventional tonnage. Local buying remains selective, with recyclers reluctant to compromise margins simply to secure additional ships. Currency conditions have been comparatively orderly, allowing the steel improvement to provide genuine support without substantially changing the broader purchasing environment.

Specialists Matter.

The latest waterfront movements continue to demonstrate Alang's ability to attract a varied selection of recycling candidates. Additional general cargo and reefer vessels arrived during the week, while previously secured tanker tonnage progressed through delivery. These movements follow the recent arrival and delivery of larger specialist units, reinforcing India's established position in a market where vessel composition matters as much as conventional steel weight. Reefers, gas carriers, passenger vessels and other non-ferrous-rich units continue to provide opportunities beyond the standard competition for ordinary bulkers and tankers. Compliance infrastructure and specialist handling capabilities remain important considerations for owners evaluating recycling destinations.

Margins First.

India's conventional market remains more restrained than its regional competitors, but this does not imply an absence of commercial opportunity. Recyclers continue to examine individual vessel characteristics carefully, particularly where additional non-ferrous value or specialist requirements can justify stronger purchasing interest. The improvement in local steel has provided a firmer foundation, although end buyers remain conscious of financing costs, loading expenses and downstream demand. For Alang, maintaining purchasing discipline while pursuing higher-value candidates remains the more practical course. The steel market has offered encouragement. The opportunity lies in turning that support into commercially worthwhile transactions rather than simply increasing the volume of purchases.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

GADANI KEEPS ITS OPTIONS OPEN

Urgency Eases.

Gadani continues to maintain healthy underlying demand, although the urgency that Gadani continues to maintain healthy underlying demand, although the urgency that characterised its earlier purchasing activity has moderated considerably. A steady arrival of previously secured vessels has helped satisfy some immediate yard requirements, allowing recyclers to approach new opportunities with greater discipline. The latest arrival adds to physical waterfront activity, but the wider market remains constrained by the limited supply of fresh recycling candidates. Buyers are still interested in suitable bulkers and tankers, provided acquisition costs can be justified against domestic steel returns. The present caution should therefore be viewed as a more balanced purchasing approach rather than evidence of a substantial deterioration in sentiment.

Steel Anchors.

Domestic plate remained unchanged at PKR 195,000 per ton throughout the week, providing a stable but unremarkable foundation for further vessel buying. The Pakistani Rupee also remained comparatively steady against the Dollar, offering predictability in transaction calculations. Finished-steel consumption continues to face a cautious environment, while imported scrap remains an important competing source of raw material for local steel production. September inflation eased to 10.26%, although financing and purchasing conditions remain challenging. With little fresh support from steel or currency movements, recyclers have limited incentive to pursue higher acquisition costs. Protecting margins remains an important consideration as yards assess future requirements.

Patience Pays.

Pakistan remains competitively positioned within the sub-continent, with buyers willing to consider workable candidates when appropriate opportunities emerge. Competition from Bangladesh continues to influence purchasing decisions, particularly where vessels can attract interest from multiple destinations. Nevertheless, Gadani's ability to secure and receive tonnage during recent months has improved its immediate operating position. The next challenge is ensuring that today's measured purchasing activity does not leave yards short of candidates in the coming months. For now, buyers are content to maintain their interest without repeating August's exceptional urgency. Gadani has retained its appetite, but no longer feels compelled to chase every available hull.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

ALIAGA HAS LITTLE ROOM TO MOVE

Scrap Softens.

Aliaga experienced a marginally weaker market this week, with domestic finished-steel demand remaining subdued and international steel conditions offering little additional support. Turkish steel values experienced a modest correction of a few Dollars, reinforcing the cautious purchasing approach already evident among recyclers. Imported scrap prices and weak downstream consumption continue to influence vessel acquisition decisions, particularly where processing and financing costs restrict achievable margins. The movement has been limited rather than a decisive deterioration, but there is little immediate encouragement for buyers to become more aggressive.

Rates Ease.

Turkey's central bank reduced its policy rate from 37% to 36% on October 22, providing a measure of financing relief after an extended period of restrictive monetary conditions. September inflation nevertheless remained elevated at 29.73%, while continued Lira weakness complicates the economics of purchasing vessels in Dollars and selling recovered material domestically. Although lower interest rates may gradually improve working capital conditions, the immediate impact on recycling demand is likely to remain modest. Steel consumption and currency stability are still the more pressing commercial considerations.

Location Matters.

Aliaga retains its established position as a regional recycling destination, particularly for European and Mediterranean tonnage where geographical proximity, repositioning costs and environmental requirements influence owners' decisions. These advantages continue to create selective opportunities despite the substantial difference between Turkish and sub-continent purchasing levels. For the present, buying interest remains cautious, with limited fresh activity and a slightly softer underlying market. Turkey retains its niche, but stronger domestic steel demand will be needed before recyclers have reason to materially improve their purchasing appetite.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly - Market Rankings

For Week 43 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Steady**	510 / LDT	530 / LDT	540 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Steady**	500 / LDT	520 / LDT	530 / LDT
3	India	**Steady**	465 / LDT	485 / LDT	495 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weaker**	290 / LDT	300-310 / LDT	320 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *Approximately 69.16 million tonnes of steel recovered through ship recycling at Alang equal the weight of reinforcing steel used in nearly **1,770 Burj Khalifa towers**.*

- *44.4 billion kWh of energy saved through ship recycling at Alang equal approximately **33 days of electricity consumption by all the world's data centres**.*

- *276 million cubic yards of landfill space saved through recycling at Alang could cover **Manhattan's entire land area with a layer approximately 3.6 metres deep**.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
November 24 – Guru Nanak's Birthday	October 25 – November 01 November 07 – November 14

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 16 – Victory Day	October 25 – October 28 November 07 – November 10

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
November 09 – Allama Iqbal Day	28–29 October 2026 – Republic Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of October 23, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Inzhener Veshnyakov	4,200	General Cargo	Arrived October 23
2	Affinis	2,920	Reefer	Arrived October 23
3	Modeste	8,767	Oil Tanker	***Delivered October 18***
4	Inzhener Trubin	4,000	General Cargo	Arrived October 17

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of October 23, 2026

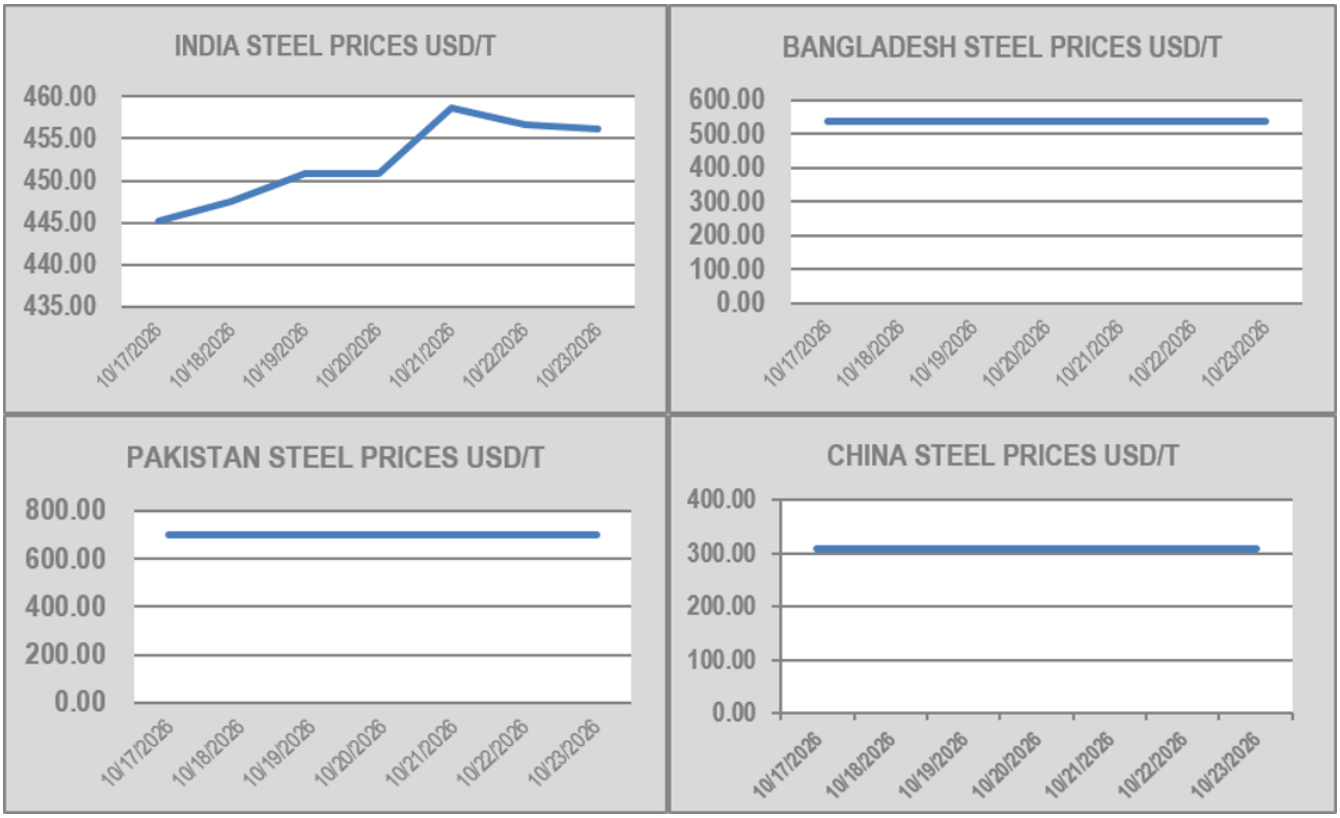
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	V. L. 15	1,427	Tanker	***Delivered October 16***
2	K.P.P. 02	1,288	Tanker	***Delivered October 16***
3	K.P.P. 03	1,336	Tanker	***Delivered October 15***
4	Pacific Leader	911	General Cargo	***Delivered October 15***
5	Uniorder	7,078	Bulk Carrier	Arrived October 15
6	Green	8,275	Tanker	Arrived October 14
7	B-LPG Sophia (D/VSL)	3,421	LPG Tanker	Arrived September 28

GADANI - Port Position as of October 23, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Sparrow	5,000	Bulk Carrier	Arrived October 21

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DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
10/17/2026	445.17	42,300.00	702.20	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	308.69
10/18/2026	447.56	42,500.00	702.20	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	308.69
10/19/2026	450.91	42,800.00	702.20	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	308.69
10/20/2026	450.91	42,800.00	702.20	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	308.69
10/21/2026	458.59	43,300.00	702.20	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	308.69
10/22/2026	456.65	43,300.00	702.20	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	308.69
10/23/2026	456.17	43,300.00	702.20	195,000.00	538.56	66,000.00	308.69



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